

LEAR FUTURE

The deal allows India to conduct civilian nuclear trade with the world

**INDIA CAN IMPORT
MUCH NEEDED FUEL
FOR ITS PLANTS**

8

**reactors to
be imported
in five years**

\$100 billion worth of nuclear commerce
in the next 20 years

**INDIA'S
WEAPONS
PROGRAMME
CAN DEVELOP
UNHINDERED**

**Sensitive technology for
reprocessing and enrichment
of fuel can now be imported**

**India can now export its
indigenously designed nuclear
reactors to other countries**

heaped on India and US firms were prevented from selling hi-tech that was even remotely connected to the word nuclear. America put pressure on the world to ostracise India and formed the 45-member Nuclear Suppliers Group (NSG) to prevent other countries from conducting nuclear trade with India. Indian nuclear scientists were made unwelcome at international seminars in their field.

Now with the Indo-US nuclear deal, the huge boulder that was blocking India's nuclear path had been lifted. For excited Indian

nuclear scientists, Prime Minister Manmohan Singh and Bush had made the impossible happen. Not only had India ended the apartheid it faced with regard to civilian nuclear trade, but the country was also incredibly allowed to carry on with its nuclear weapons programme unhindered. It was a privilege only the so-called P5 nations—the US, Russia, France, UK and China—enjoyed. India has now joined the exclusive club of the nuclear haves. As M.R. Srinivasan, a former chairman of the Atomic Energy Commission,

put it: "For all practical purposes we are now recognised by the world as a nuclear weapons state."

To achieve that, the US had to expend voluminous political capital that began on July 18, 2005 with Bush and Manmohan signing a landmark agreement to remove the nuclear obstacle from bilateral relations. The Bush administration got the US Congress to pass the Hyde Act, amending the Atomic Energy Act that had prohibited American entities from trading with countries that didn't sign the NPT or had done a nuclear test—